

had launched 4G services across the nation. When RIL launched 4G VoLTE nationwide, it did not give customers the 3G option. Rivals were still offering a choice of 3G or 4G SIM cards, which required users to upgrade their handsets.

VoLTE, or voice over long-term evolution, sends voice calls over the internet in packets, which makes it great for video calls or just talking while your social media apps refresh content.

For RIL, the Jio gambit was just another way it leveraged technology across businesses. In its traditional polyester business, it worked with DuPont to understand the nuances. If it was VoLTE for telecom, taking the standalone 5G (a network that stands alone without depending on existing infrastructure) was intentional since it leads to lower latency, better use of spectrum, and wider coverage.

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## AI IT IS

Technology has been a key driver at RIL right from its days as a textiles company and later in petrochemicals and other sectors. Those who know RIL well say it is today “a technology company”. Tech drives its traditional oil-to-chemicals (O2C) business, the largest revenue contributor at 56% (almost ₹5.65 lakh crore out of over ₹10 lakh crore). Technology also drives its retail business, now at ₹3.07 lakh crore. RIL’s tech business has hit ₹1.33 lakh crore in less than a decade.

At RIL’s August 2024 annual general meeting of shareholders, Chairman & Managing Director Mukesh Ambani mapped the path ahead: it was to be “a deep-tech and advanced manufacturing company.” What stood out was the repeated mention and emphasis on artificial intelligence (AI). Jio’s vision, as Ambani put it, was AI everywhere for everyone. “To

## REPORT CARD

➤ *Reliance Industries has retained the top spot in the BT500 list of India’s most valuable companies*

➤ *Its average market cap rose 12.8% during the study period*

| Company Name                     | Reliance Industries |
|----------------------------------|---------------------|
| 2024/2023 Rank                   | 1/1                 |
| Average Market Cap* (Change YoY) | 18,89,480 (12.8)    |
| Total income (Change YoY)        | 9,17,121 (3)        |
| PAT (Change YoY)                 | 79,020 (7)          |
| TTM P/E Multiple                 | 47.16               |

**NOTE** DATA AS OF NOVEMBER 25, 2024; \* FROM OCTOBER 1, 2023 TO SEPTEMBER 30, 2024; TOTAL INCOME, PAT AND ROE FOR FY24; P/E: PRICE-TO-EARNINGS; AVERAGE MARKET CAP, TOTAL INCOME AND PAT IN ₹ CRORE; TTM IS TRAILING 12 MONTHS; FIGURES IN BRACKETS INDICATE YOY CHANGE IN %; RESULTS ARE ON A CONSOLIDATED BASIS; **SOURCE** ACE EQUITY

achieve this, we are laying the groundwork for a truly national AI infrastructure. We plan to establish gigawatt-scale AI-ready data centres at Jamnagar, powered entirely by Reliance’s green energy, reflecting our commitment to sustainability and a greener future,” he said.

Ambani said Reliance was “the only company with such access to green power” and uniquely positioned to lead the transformation. The plan is to create multiple AI inference facilities across captive locations to scale up and support growing demand. Simultaneously, Reliance will partner with “leading global technology companies and innovators to bring the most advanced AI models, solutions, and tools to India.”

Four sectors—agriculture, education, healthcare, and small businesses—are expected to benefit the most from AI. It could be

farmers using intelligent tools to conserve water, making accurate weather predictions, teachers personalising learning experiences, AI doctors being accessible everywhere, or small businesses using it to achieve high levels of innovation and productivity.

If 4G has transformed voice and data, 5G will be big in IoT. Company trackers say RIL can compete with information technology majors. Almost everyone has access to technology, but the challenge lies in adapting technology for one’s business. For RIL, getting it right is just one part of the story. The other part is scale, the real differentiator. “It produces the network effect, makes data ubiquitous, and, with lower costs, drives down unit economics. In the absence of scale, all this is not easy to achieve,” they say.

At the AGM, Ambani said Reliance was targeting “doubling its

